operating systems. Hardware virtualization technology is essential here too, so your CPU needs to support Intel VT-x or AMD-V technology. It offers command-line tools, but it also has a graphical virtual manager, which is very similar to other virtual machine software.

KVM is supported by many platforms like Linux, Windows, Mac OS X, BSD, Solaris, etc. The Virtual Machine Manager application of KVM lets you create new virtual machines. KVM is still in a nascent stage and lacks a few features that Hyper-V has, but it does perform better and hardly ever crashes.

VirtualBox and VMware Player works great for users of Windows and Linux, catering to the ones who want more freedom to customize. Parallels or Fusion is preferred for Mac users, which have an easier form of virtualization, intended for regular users.

Note: Running operating systems on virtual machine are fine as long as you're using licensed versions of the operating systems (Windows, Mac, and some Linux distributions).

Running software on other platforms

There are a few tools and software that let you run applications originally made for another operating system on your own operating system. You can, for example, run Linux software on your Windows system or run Windows software on a Linux system, if that tickles your fancy. Let's look at a few of these preferred solutions.

1. Wine: Wine is an implementation of the Windows API and a compatibility layer software application that lets you run Windows software on Unix-like operating systems. This means you can run your desired software made for Windows on your Linux or Mac system. Wine provides you with its software library Winelib, so that developers can compile applications for Windows on Unix-like systems. What Wine basically does is, when an application needs to run, it requests certain resources from the operating system. These requests are handled by DLL files on Windows, which is substituted by Wine, providing alternate implementations to the DLL calling system. To avoid any copyright issues, Wine is completely written using black-box testing reverse-engineering.

Installing Wine on a Linux system isn't too difficult, while it is slightly tedious on a Mac. No emulation occurs when a software is run on an